

WINDOWS · MYSQL SERVER 8.0

MySQL 8.0 Password Recovery

A reliable root-password reset process using Command Prompt.

Windows

MySQL Server 8.0

7 Steps

```
C:\> net stop MySQL80
```

```
The MySQL80 service is  
stopping...
```

```
mysql> ALTER USER 'root'@  
      'localhost' IDENTIFIED  
      BY 'NewPassword';  
Query OK, 0 rows affected
```

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STEP 1 OF 7

Stop MySQL

Shut down the running Windows service before starting recovery mode.

Open Command Prompt as Administrator, then run:



```
C:\> net stop MySQL80
```

WHY THIS STEP

This stops the MySQL80 Windows service so a temporary recovery server can be started in its place, without the standard service holding the port and data files.

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STEP 2 OF 7

Start MySQL in Password-Reset Mode

Launch a temporary server that skips privilege checks.

In the same window, run the server with your actual configuration file:



```
"C:\Program Files\MySQL\MySQL Server 8.0\bin\mysqld.exe"  
  --defaults-file="C:\ProgramData\MySQL\MySQL Server 8.0\my.ini"  
  --skip-grant-tables --named-pipe --socket=MySQL --console
```



Keep this window open. It runs the temporary recovery server in the foreground — closing it ends the session.

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STEP 3 OF 7

Connect Without a Password

Open a second Administrator window to reach the temporary server.

Open a second Administrator Command Prompt, then run:

```
"C:\Program Files\MySQL\MySQL Server 8.0\bin\mysql.exe"  
--protocol=PIPE --socket=MySQL -u root
```

If successful, the MySQL prompt appears:

```
mysql>
```

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STEP 4 OF 7

Reset the Root Password

Refresh privilege tables, then set the new password.

At the mysql> prompt, run:



```
mysql> FLUSH PRIVILEGES;
```

Then set the new password:



```
mysql> ALTER USER 'root'@'localhost'  
IDENTIFIED BY 'YourNewPassword';
```

-- Example:

```
mysql> ALTER USER 'root'@'localhost'  
IDENTIFIED BY 'MyStrongPass@2026';
```

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STEP 5 OF 7

Exit the MySQL Client

Close the client session in the second window.

After changing the password, run:



```
mysql> exit
```

RESULT

This returns you to the ordinary Windows Command Prompt.

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STEP 6 OF 7

Stop the Temporary Server

Shut down the recovery instance from the first window.

Return to the first Command Prompt window, then press:

Ctrl + C

WHY THIS STEP

This stops the temporary MySQL server running with `--skip-grant-tables`, so the instance no longer bypasses privilege checks.

7

STEP 7 OF 7

Start MySQL Normally

Bring the standard service back online with the new password active.

Open an Administrator Command Prompt if needed, then run:



```
C:\> net start MySQL80
```



Done. MySQL should now start normally, and the root account will use the new password you set.

RECAP

Recovery Process — Quick Summary

- 1 Stop MySQL80
- 2 Start mysqld with `--skip-grant-tables`
- 3 Connect as root without a password
- 4 `FLUSH PRIVILEGES;`
- 5 `ALTER USER` to set a new password
- 6 Exit client, stop the temporary server
- 7 Start MySQL80 normally